


LEVEL 1 • TERM 3 • LESSON 9 • FOR PARENTS

# 9 Spot the Mistake

## WHAT WE DID

We learnt that a neat answer can still be wrong. Your child checked sums a second way, sorted right and wrong sum cards, found the one wrong step, and spotted a wrong time and a wrong total. Telling that an answer cannot be right by thinking about how big it must be (an estimate), and spotting the wrong digit in a column sum, go past the school Primary 1 syllabus on purpose. Please say about and near; do not teach rounding to the nearest ten.

> **A wrong answer leaves a clue. Check it a different way.**

## TRY AT HOME (5 MINUTES)

1. Write three take-away sums. Ask your child to check each by adding back. Make one wrong on purpose.
2. Find the wrong step: 45 + 38. Step 1: 45 + 30 = 75. Step 2: 75 + 8 = 85. (Step 2 is wrong: it is 83.)
3. Say a time that cannot be right: half an hour after half past 4 is 4:60. Can your child say the right time?

### When your child is stuck

Let your child use the cards, a number line or a clock and wait 10 seconds before helping. Asking 'What do you get if you add it back?' works better than giving the answer. Please say 'the sum has a mistake', not 'you made a mistake'. If the look-back page says 'I am still stuck', photograph it and send it to our business WhatsApp (+65 9880 5962). Photos are kept 90 days after the program ends.

### Words we used

- check: do it a different way
- add back: the answer plus the number taken away
- wrong step: the one step that went wrong
- about: near, not exact
- a clue: how far the wrong answer is from the right one

### Good questions

- How can you check it another way?
- Which step is wrong?
- How far is it from the right answer?

### Have ready for next lesson

- Your Term 3 book: tear out the calendar page along the dashed line, then a grown-up cuts out the 7 day cards (the month page is not cut)
- Mi's Challenge Quest Log (4 pages, in your Term 3 book), kept closed in an envelope
- A quest partner: a grown-up, brother or sister
- Pencil, rubber and paper

## Next lesson

Next lesson: Calendar Detective, the last lesson of Term 3. It also holds Mi's Challenge Quest, a game with Mi. Online practice: your tutor will share the link. The recording has the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted; your child may mute and keep the camera off. The recording link is private to your family: please do not share it. Missed a lesson? Every lesson is recorded; your tutor will share a private link with enrolled families.

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